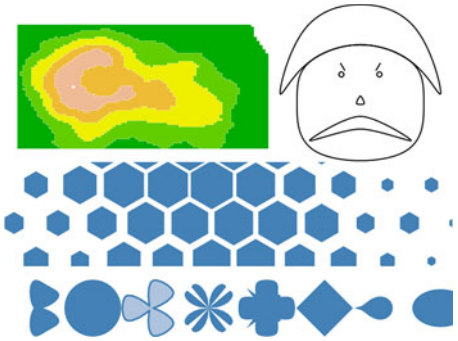
D3 PLUGINS The core d3.js library that you download comes with quite a few layouts and useful functions, but you can find even more at https://github.com/d3/d3-plugins. Besides the two noncore layouts discussed in this chapter, we'll look at the geo plugins in chapter 7 when we deal with maps. Also available is a fisheye distortion lens, a canned boxplot layout, a layout for horizon charts, and more exotic plugins for Chernoff faces and implementing the superformula.



The data is a JSON array of nodes and a second JSON array of links. Get used to this format, because it's the format of most of the network data we'll use in chapter 6. For our example, we'll look at the traffic flow in a website that sells milk and milk-based products. We want to see how visitors move through the site from the homepage to the store page to the various product pages. In the parlance of the data format we need to work with, the nodes are the web pages, the links are the visitors who go from one page to another (if any), and the value of each link is the total number of visitors who move from that page to the next.

Listing 5.6 sitestats.json

```
{
  "nodes":[
    {"name":"index"},
    {"name":"about"},
    {"name":"contact"},
    {"name":"store"},
    {"name":"cheese"},
    {"name":"yoghurt"},
    {"name":"milk"}
  ],
  "links":[
    {"source":0,"target":1,"value":25},
    {"source":0,"target":2,"value":10},
    {"source":0,"target":3,"value":40},
    {"source":1,"target":2,"value":10},
    {"source":3,"target":4,"value":25},
    {"source":3,"target":5,"value":10},
    {"source":3,"target":6,"value":5},
    {"source":4,"target":6,"value":5},
    {"source":4,"target":5,"value":15}
  ]
}
```

Each entry in this array represents a web page.

Each entry in this array represents the number of times someone navigated from the "source" page to the "target" page.

The nodes array is clear—each object represents a web page. The links array is a bit more opaque, until you realize the numbers represent the array position of nodes in the node array. So when `links[0]` reads `"source": 0`, it means that the source is